

Sapien

Company-Wide

Policies

June 2025

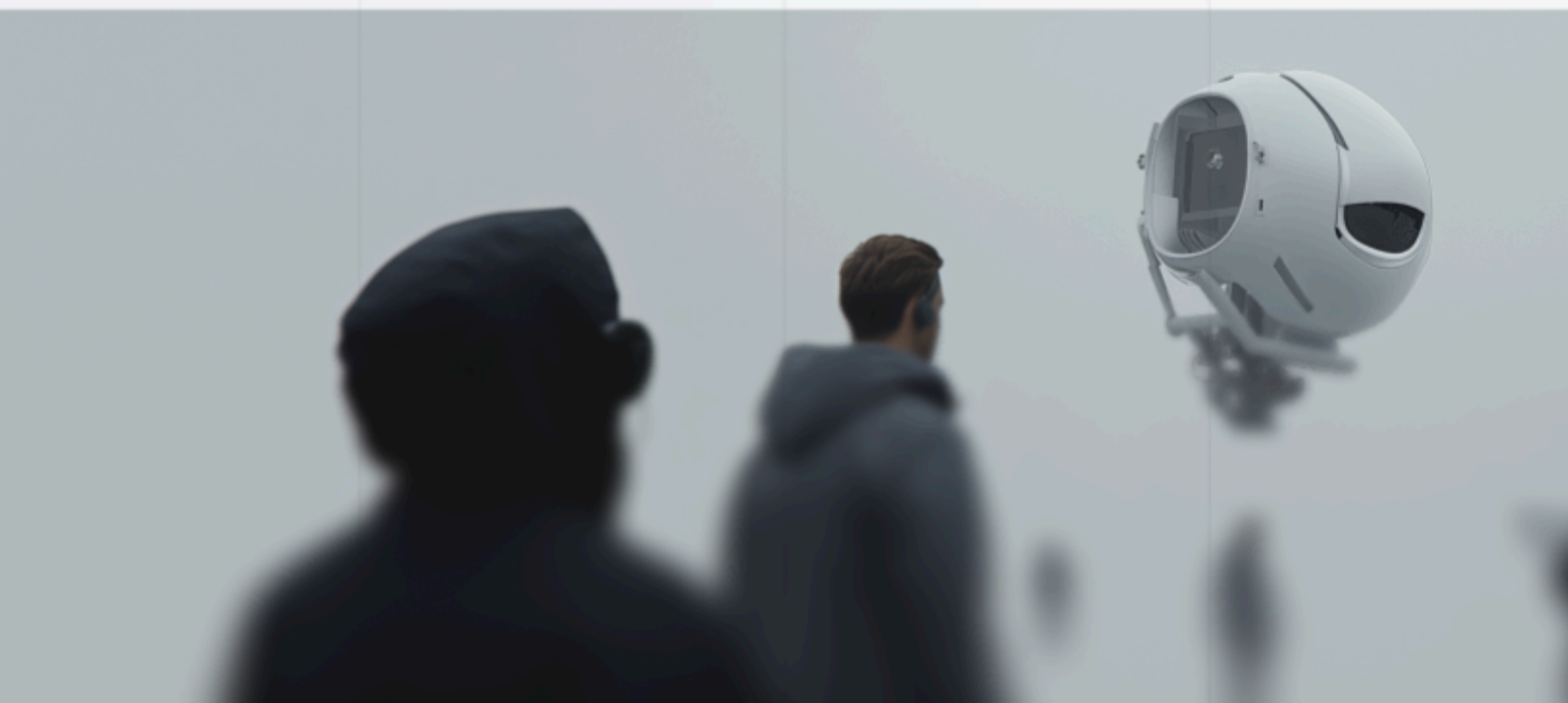


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1. Purpose

The purpose of this handbook is to establish clear and transparent policies for all employees of Sapien AI. These policies are designed to:

- Define the rights, responsibilities, and expectations of employees.
- Ensure compliance with relevant legal and regulatory requirements.
- Support a productive, inclusive, and high-performing work environment.
- Provide guidance on employee benefits, workplace behavior, technology use, and other critical aspects of employment.
- Promote fairness and accountability while fostering a culture of trust and mutual respect.

This document serves as a reference guide for all employees and management to ensure a clear understanding of company policies and procedures.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees of Sapien AI, including full-time, part-time, and contract workers.
- Remote and international employees, ensuring a consistent approach across different locations.
- Management and leadership, who are responsible for enforcing and upholding these policies.
- Third-party contractors and consultants, where applicable, to ensure compliance with company standards.

These policies cover all aspects of employment, including:

- Perks and benefits
- Workplace expectations and conduct
- Technology use and confidentiality
- Legal compliance and disciplinary actions
- Performance expectations and feedback processes

Where employment laws vary significantly by jurisdiction, Sapien will align internal policy practices with local legal requirements in good faith. Employees should consult HR for country-specific clarifications. These policies are subject to updates and modifications as needed to reflect changes in company operations, legal requirements, and industry best practices.

3. Policy Updates

Sapien AI is committed to ensuring that company policies remain compliant with applicable laws, and aligned with business needs. This section outlines how and when policies may be updated and how employees will be informed of changes.

3.1 Policy Review and Revisions

- Company policies will be reviewed annually or as needed to reflect changes in laws, regulations, and company practices.
- Updates may also be made based on employee feedback, operational needs, or industry best practices.
- Any amendments will be reviewed by legal counsel and senior leadership before implementation.

3.2 Notification of Policy Changes

- Employees will be notified of policy updates via company-wide emails, internal communication platforms (e.g., Slack, Rippling), or official company meetings.
- Significant changes will be accompanied by explanatory documents or training sessions to ensure employees understand the impact of the updates.
- Employees are responsible for reviewing and acknowledging policy updates as required.

3.3 Employee Acknowledgment

- Employees may be required to electronically acknowledge updates in the HR system to confirm they have read and understood the changes.
- Continued employment at Sapien AI implies agreement to abide by the most current policies.

3.4 Questions and Clarifications

- Employees seeking clarification on policy changes can contact HR@sapien.io for further explanation.
- Feedback on company policies is welcomed and may be submitted to HR or leadership for consideration in future updates.

4. Definitions

The following definitions apply throughout this document:

- **Employee** – Any individual employed by Sapien AI, including full-time, part-time, contract, and remote workers.
- **Manager** – A person responsible for overseeing employees and ensuring compliance with company policies.
- **Contractor** – A non-employee engaged in a professional relationship with Sapien AI for a specific project or duration.
- **Confidential Information** – Any non-public company data, including financials, client data, internal communications, and proprietary technology.
- **Remote Work** – A work arrangement where employees perform their job duties outside of a traditional office setting.
- **Maternity/Paternity Leave** – Job-protected leave provided to employees in connection with the birth or adoption of a child.
- **Sick Leave** – Paid or unpaid leave granted to employees for illness, injury, or medical emergencies.
- **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)** – A structured program designed to support employees in improving their performance in specific areas.
- **Equity/Options** – Stock options or other financial instruments granted to employees and advisors as part of their compensation package.
- **Core Collaboration Hours** – The set hours during which all employees must be available for meetings and communication, ensuring effective collaboration across time zones.
- **IT Acceptable Use** – Guidelines for how employees must use company-provided technology and systems.

5. Perks

5.1 Benefits

At Sapien, we strive to support the health, well-being, and financial security of our employees. This policy outlines the benefits available to our team members, ensuring transparency and fairness while accommodating our global workforce.

1. Canadian Employees

- All Canadian employees are entitled to full benefits coverage through our provider, [Beneva](#).
- Coverage includes:
 - Health Insurance: Prescription drugs, hospital services, and paramedical services (e.g., physiotherapy, chiropractic care).
 - Dental Insurance: Routine exams, cleanings, and major procedures.
 - Vision Care: Eye exams, glasses, and contact lenses.
- Employees will receive full details of the Beneva plan during onboarding.

2. International Employees

- Case-by-Case Basis:
 - Benefits for international employees are determined based on location, role, and local legal requirements.
 - Sapien AI aims to provide equitable support, which may include health insurance, wellness stipends, or other benefits customized to the employee's location.
- Process:
 - HR will work directly with international employees to identify and implement suitable benefits options.
 - Any questions or requests can be sent to HR@sapien.io.

Eligibility

- Full-time employees are eligible for benefits starting on their first day of employment per HR - Onboarding Funnel.
- Part-time and contract employees are not eligible for benefits unless explicitly stated in their contract.

Flexibility

- Sapien is committed to regularly reviewing and enhancing our benefits offerings to ensure they remain competitive and supportive of our diverse workforce.

Questions?

For more information or to discuss specific benefit details, contact HR@sapien.io.

5.2 Remote Work

Sapien operates as a fully remote company, enabling employees to work flexibly while maintaining productivity and collaboration. This policy outlines expectations for all employees to ensure consistency, accountability, and a positive remote work environment.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Sapien, regardless of location. It establishes guidelines for work hours, communication, and maintaining a professional and productive remote work setup.

Guidelines for Remote Work

1. Work Hours and Availability

- Employees are expected to follow their agreed-upon work schedules.
- Employees are expected to be available for meetings and real-time communication during their region's core collaboration hours. For additional details, refer to Section 6.5: Attendance and Time Keeping.
- Flexibility is allowed outside of core hours, provided deadlines and responsibilities are met.

2. Communication and Collaboration

- Employees must stay connected via company-approved communication tools (e.g., Slack, gmail).
- Respond to messages and requests within reasonable timeframes (e.g., within 24 hours unless urgent).
- Video conferencing is encouraged for team meetings to foster collaboration and connection.

3. Workspace Requirements

- Employees must have a dedicated, safe, and secure workspace with a reliable internet connection.
- Sapien AI may provide reimbursement or allowances for home office equipment, such as desks, chairs, and monitors, as outlined in the Expense Reimbursement Policy.

4. Security and IT Compliance

- All employees must comply with the IT and Acceptable Use Policy, ensuring company data is secure.
- Use strong passwords, enable two-factor authentication, and access company systems only via secure networks (e.g., VPN).
- Report any IT issues, data breaches, or lost/stolen devices immediately to IT@sapien.io

5. Performance Expectations

- Remote employees are held to the same performance standards as on-site roles.
- Regular check-ins and performance reviews will ensure employees are meeting objectives and maintaining accountability.

Company Support for Remote Work

1. Equipment and Tools

- Sapien AI provides employees with necessary tools, software, and equipment to perform their roles effectively.
- Requests for additional resources must be approved by the employee's manager and/or HR.

2. Wellness and Work-Life Balance

- Employees are encouraged to take regular breaks and establish boundaries between work and personal life.
- Managers are available to provide support in balancing workload and addressing challenges unique to remote work.

Reporting Issues

For any challenges related to remote work, including technical difficulties or workspace concerns, employees should contact their manager or HR@sapien.io for assistance.

5.3 Vacation

Sapien believes in a culture that prioritizes trust, flexibility, and work-life balance. Our **unlimited vacation policy** empowers employees to take the time they need to recharge, ensuring they remain productive and engaged.

Eligibility

All full-time employees are eligible for unlimited vacation starting from their first day of employment.

Guidelines

1. *Communication and Approval:*

- Vacation time must be scheduled in advance and approved by your manager to ensure team coverage and minimal disruption to business operations.
- Provide at least two weeks' notice for extended vacations (five or more consecutive business days).

2. *Reasonable Use:*

- Employees are encouraged to take at least 15 days off annually to maintain a healthy work-life balance.
- Unlimited vacation is subject to reasonable use and should not negatively impact project deadlines or team performance.

3. *Tracking:*

- While time off is unlimited, employees must log vacation days in [Rippling](#) for record-keeping and team planning.

Exclusions

- Unlimited vacation applies only to personal time off. It does not cover sick leave, bereavement leave, or other specific types of leave, which are handled under separate policies.

Key Principles

- *Trust and Accountability:* Employees are trusted to manage their workload effectively and coordinate with their teams before taking time off.
- *Work-Life Balance:* Taking vacation is essential for overall well-being and productivity. Managers will encourage time off where appropriate.

Approval Denials

- In rare cases, a vacation request may be denied due to critical business needs, but every effort will be made to accommodate alternative dates.

Questions?

For guidance or clarification, contact HR@sapien.io

5.4 Sick Leave and Absences

Sapien values the health and well-being of its employees. This policy provides guidelines for taking time off due to illness, injury, or other personal emergencies while ensuring compliance with Ontario's Employment Standards Act (ESA) and maintaining flexibility for our fully remote workforce.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Sapien, including full-time, part-time, and contract employees, regardless of their location.

Sick Leave Guidelines

1. Paid Sick Leave

- Full-time employees are entitled to **up to 3 paid sick days per calendar year** in compliance with Ontario's ESA.
- Sick days can be used for:
 - Personal illness, injury, or medical emergencies.
 - Attending medical appointments.
 - Short-term mental health needs.

2. Unpaid Sick Leave

- Employees are eligible for up to 3 additional unpaid days per year for personal illness, in accordance with Ontario law.
- For longer absences due to illness or injury, employees may be eligible for job-protected unpaid leave under the ESA (e.g., extended illness or family medical leave).

Remote Work and Sick Leave

- If unwell but capable of working, employees may choose to work reduced hours or adjust their schedule with their manager's approval.
- If unable to work due to illness, employees should take the necessary time off to rest and recover.

Notification Process

- Employees must notify their manager or HR@sapien.io as soon as possible if they need to take sick leave.
- Provide an estimated return-to-work date and any updates if the absence extends longer than expected.
- For absences longer than 5 consecutive business days, a medical note may be required.

Medical Appointments

- Employees are encouraged to schedule non-urgent medical appointments outside of core collaboration hours.
- If appointments conflict with work hours, notify your manager in advance to coordinate coverage.

Job Protection

- Employees taking sick leave are protected under Ontario's ESA, ensuring job security during their absence.
- Upon returning from sick leave, employees will resume their previous role or an equivalent one.

Workplace Wellness Support

- Sapien supports employee well-being through:
 - Access to health and wellness resources, including the Employee Assistance Program (EAP)
 - Encouraging open communication about health-related needs.

Fraudulent Use of Sick Leave

- Failure to adhere to this policy may lead to appropriate corrective action, which could include, in serious cases, termination of employment or contractual engagement.

Questions?

For additional guidance or to discuss specific circumstances, contact HR@sapien.io

5.5 Sapien Leave & Time-Off Summary

Leave Type	Eligibility	Duration	Paid?	Notes
Vacation	All employees	15 days/year (standard)	✓ Yes	Accrues monthly. Must be approved in advance.
Sick Leave	All employees	Up to 5 days/year	✓ Yes	Inform manager and HR ASAP. A doctor's note may be required.
Personal Emergency Leave	Canada (ESA), Intl (as local law permits)	3 unpaid days (Canada ESA)	✗ Unpaid (ESA)	Covers illness, family emergencies, etc. Can combine with sick leave.
Bereavement Leave	All employees	3 days per immediate family loss	✓ Yes	Notify HR and manager. Extendable with vacation if needed.
Parental Leave	ESA-eligible or by local law	Up to 61–63 weeks in Canada	✗ or EI-based	Canadian employees may qualify for EI. Intl per local laws.
Maternity Leave	ESA-eligible or by local law	Up to 17 weeks (Canada)	✗ or EI-based	Typically followed by Parental Leave.
Unpaid Leave of Absence	Discretionary (approval required)	Case-by-case	✗ No	Approval required by manager & HR. For education, personal travel, etc.
Statutory Holidays	Based on location (e.g. Canadian province)	~10/year (Canada)	✓ Yes	Employees must follow holidays in their country/province of residence.
Religious / Cultural Days	All employees (on request)	1–2 days/year (flexible)	✓ or ✗ Case-by-case	Encourage inclusion; unpaid if extra beyond statutory holidays.

5.6 Employee Referral

Sapien AI values the power of employee networks in identifying top talent. This policy outlines the guidelines for our Employee Referral Program, which rewards employees for referring candidates who are successfully hired.

Eligibility

- All active employees of Sapien AI are eligible to participate, except for:
 - Managers hiring for their own teams.
 - Members of the HR or recruiting team.

Referral Guidelines

- *Who Can Be Referred:*
 - Candidates referred must not have applied to or been contacted by Sapien AI within the past 12 months.
 - Referrals must align with Sapien AI's hiring needs and open positions listed on [careers page or internal job board].
- *How to Submit a Referral:*
 - Referrals must be submitted through HR@sapien.io, including the candidate's resume and relevant details.
- *Referral Timelines:*
 - Referrals must be submitted before the candidate applies directly or is contacted by Sapien AI.

Referral Bonus

- *Reward Amounts:*
 - **\$1,000 CAD** for successful hires of junior-level positions.
 - **\$2,500 CAD** for successful hires of senior-level or specialized positions.
- *Payment Process:*
 - Bonuses will be paid out in two installments:
 - 50% after the new hire's completion of the first 90 days.
 - 50% after the new hire completes 6 months with Sapien AI.
- *Taxes:*
 - Referral bonuses are subject to applicable taxes and deductions as required by law.

Program Rules

- Only one referral bonus will be paid per candidate. If multiple employees refer to the same candidate, the bonus will go to the first referrer.
- Employees cannot refer to themselves or family members (e.g., spouse, parent, sibling).
- Referrals should represent Sapien AI's values and qualifications for the role. Any misuse of the program (e.g., submitting ineligible candidates) may result in disqualification.

Benefits of Participation

- Help grow the Sapien AI team with talented individuals who align with our mission.
- Strengthen the company culture by bringing in trusted connections.
- Receive financial rewards for contributing to our success.

Questions?

For more information about the referral program or to check the status of a referral, contact HR@sapien.io

6. Core

6.1 Expense Reimbursement

Sapien is committed to reimbursing employees for legitimate, reasonable, and necessary business expenses incurred while performing their duties. This policy ensures clarity and consistency in the submission and approval of expenses.

Eligible Expenses

Expenses must be pre-approved by a manager (if applicable) and align with the following categories:

1. *Travel Expenses*
 - Airfare: Economy class unless approved otherwise.
 - Accommodation: Mid-range hotels or corporate rates.
 - Ground Transportation: Ride-sharing services, public transit, taxis, or rental cars (economy class).
2. *Per Diem:*
 - Meals: Up to **\$75/day** CAD (inclusive of taxes and tips).
 - Incidentals: Up to **\$20/day** CAD.
3. *Business Expenses*
 - Client meals or entertainment (pre-approved).
 - Conference or event fees.
 - Business-related subscriptions or tools.
4. *Other Expenses*
 - Miscellaneous business expenses with prior approval.
 - Non-Reimbursable Expenses
 - Personal entertainment (e.g., movies, personal subscriptions).
 - Alcohol (unless pre-approved for client meetings).
 - Fines or penalties (e.g., parking tickets).
 - Expenses without proper documentation or approval.

Submission Process

1. *Documentation Required:*
 - Itemized receipts with the vendor name, date, and amount.
 - Explanation of the expense and its business purpose.
2. *Submission Timeline:*
 - **Submit expenses within 30 days of incurring them.**
3. *Approval Process:*
 - Submit expense reports via [Rippling](#) or directly to expenses@sapien.io

- Approval by the direct manager or designated approver is required.

Reimbursement Timeline

- Approved expenses will be reimbursed within 10 business days via the employee's payroll or designated payment method.

Audit and Compliance

- Sapien reserves the right to audit expense claims for accuracy and legitimacy.
- Failure to adhere to this policy may lead to appropriate corrective action, which could include, in serious cases, termination of employment or contractual engagement.

Questions?

For guidance or clarification, contact HR@sapien.io

6.2 Maternity and Paternity Leave

Sapien is committed to supporting employees as they balance family and work responsibilities. This policy provides guidelines for maternity and paternity leave, ensuring employees have the time and flexibility to care for their new family member.

Eligibility

All full-time employees who have worked with Sapien AI for at least 13 weeks before the leave begins are eligible for maternity or paternity leave, in accordance with the Ontario Employment Standards Act (ESA).

Maternity Leave

1. Duration:

- **Up to 17 weeks of unpaid leave for employees giving birth.**

2. Notice:

- Provide at least 2 weeks' written notice before the start of the leave, along with a medical certificate (if requested).

Paternity/Parental Leave

1. Duration:

- **Up to 63 weeks of unpaid leave for non-birthing parents.**

- Employees giving birth are eligible for an additional 61 weeks of parental leave after maternity leave.

2. *Notice:*

- Provide at least 2 weeks' written notice before the leave begins.

Sapien AI Top-Up Program (*Optional Based on Budget*)

- To support employees further, Sapien AI provides a maternity/paternity top-up to Employment Insurance (EI) benefits:
 - **Top-Up: Up to 75% of regular salary for the first 6 weeks of leave.**

Benefits Continuation

- Employees' benefits (health, dental, etc.) will continue during the leave period, provided they arrange for continued premium payments, if applicable.

Job Protection

- Upon return, employees are entitled to their previous position or a comparable one, as per the Ontario ESA.

Flexible Return Options

- Sapien AI supports flexible arrangements for employees returning from leave, including reduced hours (subject to business needs).

Note: This policy aligns with the Ontario ESA and relevant employment laws. For questions or assistance, contact HR@sapien.io

6.3 Termination

Sapien AI is committed to handling all employment terminations with fairness, respect, and in accordance with the applicable laws. In rare instances where employment must be concluded, we follow fair and lawful procedures as outlined in Ontario's Employment Standards Act (ESA). This policy sets out the procedures for both voluntary and involuntary terminations to ensure transparency, consistency, and legal compliance.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Sapien AI, regardless of employment type or location.

Types of Termination

1. Voluntary Termination (Resignation)

- Employees who choose to resign must provide a written notice of resignation to their manager or HR.
- A minimum of two weeks' notice is requested but not mandatory unless specified in the employment contract.
- Employees must return all company equipment and ensure any outstanding work is transitioned appropriately.

2. Involuntary Termination

- *Without Cause:*
 - Employees terminated without cause will receive notice or pay in lieu of notice, as well as severance pay (if applicable), in compliance with Ontario's ESA.
 - The specific amount of notice/pay will depend on the employee's length of service and the terms of their employment agreement.
- *With Cause:*
 - Termination for cause may occur due to serious misconduct, dishonesty, breach of company policy, or other significant issues.
 - In such cases, the employee may not be entitled to notice or severance.

Notice and Final Pay

- Employees will receive their final paycheck, including:
 - Outstanding wages.
 - Payment for unused vacation days (if applicable).
 - Any other entitlements under their employment agreement.
- Final pay will be issued within 7 days of termination or the next regular pay period, as required by Ontario law.

Return of Company Property

- Employees must return all company-issued equipment, including laptops, devices, and access cards, by their last working day.
- Failure to return property may result in deductions from the final pay (if permitted by law) or legal action.

Exit Interviews

- Employees leaving Sapien AI may be asked to participate in an exit interview to provide feedback about their experience.
- Feedback will be used to improve workplace practices and policies.

Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure

- Employees must continue to honor any confidentiality or non-disclosure agreements after termination.
- Any proprietary information or company data must not be shared or used post-employment.

Termination Process For Managers and HR:

- Review the employee's contract and ensure compliance with ESA and company policies.
- Document the reasons for termination (if applicable).
- Prepare the termination letter, final pay calculation, and any severance details.
- Notify the employee in a private meeting or call, maintaining professionalism and compassion.

Support for Employees

Sapien AI is committed to supporting employees during termination by:

- Offering resources for job searching or resume building.
- Providing mental health support or referrals to counseling services, if applicable.

Dispute Resolution

- Employees who believe their termination was handled improperly may submit a formal complaint to HR@sapien.io. Sapien AI will review and respond to all complaints in a timely manner.

6.4 IT and Acceptable Use

This policy establishes guidelines for the proper use of Sapien's technology, systems, and data. It ensures that all employees use IT resources responsibly and securely to protect company assets and maintain productivity.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and other authorized users who access Sapien's IT resources, including but not limited to:

- Computers, laptops, and mobile devices.
- Software and cloud services.
- Email, messaging platforms, and internet access.
- Any other tools or systems provided by Sapien.

Acceptable Use

1. General Guidelines

- Use company IT resources for business purposes only, unless otherwise authorized (e.g., limited personal use is permitted during breaks).
- Follow all applicable laws and company policies when using IT resources.
- Protect company devices from theft, damage, and unauthorized access.

2. Security Practices

- Use strong, unique passwords and update them regularly.
- Lock your computer or device when not in use.
- Report any suspicious emails, links, or potential phishing attempts to IT@sapien.io immediately.
- Ensure sensitive data is shared only over secure, company-approved channels (e.g., encrypted email, VPN).

3. Software and Systems

- Use only company-approved software, applications, and tools.
- Do not download, install, or use unauthorized software on company devices.
- Report any issues or malfunctions with IT resources to IT@sapien.io promptly.

4. Internet and Email Use

- Use the internet responsibly and only for work-related purposes.
- Avoid accessing inappropriate or non-business-related websites.
- Use company email accounts for professional communication; refrain from using personal email for work purposes.
- Do not open attachments or links from unknown or untrusted sources.

Prohibited Actions

- The following actions are strictly prohibited:
- Sharing login credentials or allowing unauthorized individuals to access company systems.
- Accessing or distributing offensive, illegal, or inappropriate content.
- Using IT resources to harass, intimidate, or discriminate against others.
- Conducting personal business, unauthorized downloads, or using company resources for non-company-related projects.
- Attempting to bypass security measures or access restricted systems.

Data Privacy and Confidentiality

- All data stored, processed, or transmitted on company systems is the property of Sapien.
- Users have no expectation of privacy when using company devices or systems.
- The company reserves the right to monitor IT resource usage for security, compliance, and performance purposes, in line with applicable laws.

Device Usage for Remote Work

- When using personal devices for work, ensure they meet company security standards (e.g., updated antivirus software, password protection).

Reporting IT Incidents

Report the following immediately to IT@sapien.io:

- Lost, stolen, or compromised devices.
- Unauthorized access or data breaches.
- Malware, phishing attempts, or suspicious activity.

Consequences of Non-Compliance

- Misuse of IT resources may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.
- Legal action may be taken in cases of intentional misconduct or breaches of security protocols.

Acknowledgment

- All employees and authorized users must sign an acknowledgment confirming they have read, understood, and agree to this policy.

Questions?

For assistance or clarification, contact IT@sapien.io

6.5 Attendance and Time Keeping

Sapien values flexibility in its fully remote work environment, but maintaining reliable attendance and accurate timekeeping is essential for productivity and team collaboration. This policy outlines expectations for attendance, working hours, and time tracking.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Sapien, regardless of location or role.

Guidelines

1. Work Hours and Flexibility

Sapien operates across North America, Europe, and Asia. To support collaboration without overloading any region, core hours are set to **10:00 AM – 3:00 PM local time** within each region. During this time, employees are expected to be available for meetings and real-time communication.

Regional Core Hours (Local Time):

- **Americas (ET):** 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM
- **EMEA (CET):** 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM (4:00 AM – 9:00 AM ET)

- **APAC (IST):** 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM (12:30 AM – 5:30 AM ET)
- **APAC (SGT):** 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM (10:00 PM – 3:00 AM ET, previous day)

These hours ensure meetings happen during reasonable daytime working hours in each region.

Global Meeting Window

For cross-regional collaboration, Sapien recommends **9:00 AM – 11:00 AM ET**, which overlaps with:

- 3:00 PM – 5:00 PM CET
- 6:30 PM – 8:30 PM IST
- 9:00 PM – 11:00 PM SGT

Teams should reserve this window for high-priority, multi-region discussions and rotate late meetings when needed. Outside of core hours, employees may work flexibly, as long as responsibilities and deadlines are met.

2. Attendance Expectations

- Employees must notify their manager as soon as possible if they are unable to work due to illness, personal emergencies, or other unexpected events.
- Planned absences, such as vacations or medical appointments, must be approved in advance by the employee's manager.

3. Overtime (if applicable)

- Overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's manager.
- Eligible employees will be compensated for overtime in accordance with Ontario's Employment Standards Act (ESA).

Remote Work Considerations

- Employees are expected to maintain a professional work routine in their remote environment.
- Communication and responsiveness during work hours are essential to team collaboration.

Late or Missed Work

- Frequent lateness, missed deadlines, or unapproved absences may result in a discussion with the manager and, if necessary, corrective action.
- Sapien AI understands that unforeseen circumstances may arise and will work with employees to address these situations on a case-by-case basis.

Reporting Absences

- Notify your manager or team via Slack or email as soon as you are aware of an absence or lateness.
- For extended absences (3 or more days), additional documentation, such as a medical note, may be required.

Consequences of Non-Compliance

- Failure to meet attendance and timekeeping expectations may result in corrective action, including but not limited to:
 - Verbal or written warnings.
 - Performance improvement plans (PIPs).
 - Termination of employment in severe or repeated cases.

Commitment to Work-Life Balance

- Sapien AI encourages employees to establish clear boundaries between work and personal life to maintain overall well-being. Managers are available to provide support in managing workloads and schedules.

Questions?

For clarification or assistance, contact HR@sapien.io

7. Behavioral

7.1 Code of Conduct

At Sapien AI, we are committed to fostering a positive, respectful, and inclusive workplace culture where all employees can thrive. This Code of Conduct outlines the expectations for behavior and professionalism to maintain a collaborative and productive environment.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, interns, and representatives of Sapien AI. It governs behavior during work hours, at work-related events, and in work-related communications (both in-person and online).

Standards of Conduct

1. Professionalism

- Employees are expected to act with integrity, diligence, and professionalism at all times.
- Communicate respectfully with colleagues, clients, and stakeholders, regardless of rank or role.

2. Respect and Inclusivity

- Treat everyone with dignity and respect, fostering an environment free from discrimination, harassment, and bullying.
- Embrace diversity in all forms, including but not limited to race, gender, age, religion, sexual orientation, and disability.

3. Confidentiality and Data Protection

- Protect company, client, and user information in accordance with Sapien AI's Confidentiality and Data Protection Policy.
- Do not share sensitive or proprietary information without proper authorization.

4. Ethical Practices

- Avoid any conflicts of interest that could compromise the company's integrity.
- Report any unethical or illegal behavior promptly to HR@sapien.io or the appropriate manager.
- Follow all applicable laws, regulations, and company policies.

5. Team Collaboration

- Support team members by contributing positively to projects, respecting deadlines, and fostering open communication.
- Constructively address conflicts and seek resolution through proper channels.

6. Use of Company Resources

- Use company equipment, systems, and tools responsibly and only for business purposes unless otherwise authorized.
- Do not engage in fraudulent or unauthorized activities using company resources.

7. Representation of Sapien AI

- When representing Sapien AI publicly (e.g., at conferences or on social media), maintain professionalism and avoid statements that could harm the company's reputation.
- Clearly distinguish personal views from company positions when sharing opinions online.

Reporting Violations

- Employees who witness or experience violations of this Code of Conduct are encouraged to report them to HR@sapien.io or their manager.
- All reports will be handled confidentially and investigated promptly.

Consequences of Misconduct

- We have zero tolerance for harassment or discrimination. Violations may lead to serious consequences, including termination
- The severity of disciplinary action will depend on the nature of the misconduct.

Commitment to Improvement

- Sapien AI encourages open dialogue and feedback to improve workplace culture.

Questions?

For more information or clarification about this policy, contact HR@sapien.io

7.2 Conflict of Interest

Sapien is committed to maintaining the highest standards of integrity and transparency. This policy ensures that employees avoid conflicts of interest that could compromise their professional judgment, Sapien's reputation, or its business interests.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and representatives of Sapien, regardless of location or role.

Definition of Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when an employee's personal, financial, or professional interests could interfere with their responsibilities or decisions at Sapien. This includes situations where personal gain, relationships, or outside activities could impact the company's interests.

Examples of Conflicts of Interest

1. *Personal Financial Interests:*

- Owning a significant stake in, or having financial ties to, a competitor, supplier, or client of Sapien.

2. *Outside Employment or Activities:*

- Working for or consulting with a competitor, supplier, or client while employed by Sapien.
- Engaging in any business activity that detracts from your ability to fulfill your Sapien responsibilities.

3. *Relationships:*

- Hiring, supervising, or influencing decisions regarding a family member or close friend.

4. *Gifts and Hospitality:*

- Accepting gifts, payments, or other benefits from clients, vendors, or partners that could influence your decisions.

5. *Use of Company Resources:*

- Using Sapien's resources (e.g., equipment, tools, or data) for personal or non-business purposes.

Employee Responsibilities

- *Disclosure:*
 - Employees must disclose any potential or actual conflicts of interest to their manager or HR@sapien.io as soon as they become aware of them.
- *Avoidance:*
 - Avoid situations that may create a conflict or appear to do so.

- Refrain from making decisions that could benefit your personal interests at the expense of Sapien.
- *Approval for Side Projects:*
 - Employees must seek approval for any outside projects, freelance work, or business ventures that could overlap with Sapien's interests.

Management of Conflicts

- *Assessment:*
 - HR and management will review disclosures to determine if a conflict exists and how to address it.
- *Resolution:*
 - Actions to resolve conflicts may include reassigning duties, requiring divestment of financial interests, or ending external engagements.
- *Confidentiality:*
 - All disclosures and related discussions will be handled with discretion and confidentiality.

Consequences of Non-Compliance

- Failure to adhere to this policy may lead to appropriate corrective action, which could include, in serious cases, termination of employment or contractual engagement.

Questions and Reporting

- Employees with questions about potential conflicts or the reporting process should contact HR@sapien.io
- Reports of conflicts may be made anonymously if desired.

Commitment to Integrity

- Sapien encourages transparency and open communication to ensure ethical and fair practices across the company.

7.3 Feedback + PIPs

At Sapien AI, we foster a culture of continuous feedback and growth. This policy outlines the process for providing constructive feedback and addressing performance concerns through structured improvement plans.

Feedback Framework

- *Ongoing Feedback:*

- Managers and team members are encouraged to provide real-time feedback during 1:1 meetings or through regular performance reviews.
- Feedback should be specific, constructive, and focused on behaviors, outcomes, and solutions.
- *Formal Reviews:*
 - Conducted biannually to evaluate performance against objectives and company values.
 - Employees receive a written summary of strengths, areas for improvement, and actionable next steps.

Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

The PIP is a formal process to address significant performance issues while supporting employee development.

- *When to Initiate a PIP:*
 - When an employee consistently fails to meet performance expectations or role requirements after regular feedback.
 - The decision is made collaboratively between the manager and HR.
- *Key Components of a PIP:*
 - Objective: Clearly define the areas requiring improvement.
 - Action Plan: Outline specific goals, milestones, and measurable outcomes.
 - Timeline: Typically 30, 60, or 90 days, based on the severity of issues.
 - Support: Provide resources, training, and regular check-ins with the manager.
- *Review Process:*
 - Regular weekly or biweekly check-ins during the PIP period to assess progress and provide guidance.
- *At the end of the PIP, the employee will either:*
 - Successfully complete the plan and return to regular duties.
 - Transition to an alternate role (if applicable and agreed upon).
 - Face termination if performance expectations remain unmet.

Confidentiality

- All feedback and PIP processes are confidential and shared only with relevant parties (manager, HR, and the employee).

Commitment to Growth

- Sapien AI views feedback and PIPs as tools for growth, not punishment. The goal is to help employees succeed while aligning with company objectives.

Questions?

For more information, contact HR@sapien.io

7.4 Social Media Policy

Sapien recognizes the power of social media in building professional connections and promoting our brand. This policy outlines the appropriate use of social media to ensure employees represent themselves and the company responsibly while maintaining confidentiality and professionalism.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and representatives of Sapien. It covers social media use on platforms such as LinkedIn, Twitter, Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, and any other online communication channels.

Guidelines for Social Media Use

- *Personal Social Media Use*
 - Employees may use personal social media accounts during breaks but must ensure it does not interfere with work responsibilities.
 - When discussing work-related topics, employees should make it clear that their views are personal and not representative of Sapien (e.g., “Opinions are my own”).
- *Representing Sapien*
 - Only authorized employees may post on official Sapien accounts or respond to media inquiries.
 - Employees are encouraged to share company content (e.g., LinkedIn posts) responsibly to promote Sapien, while maintaining a professional tone.
- *Confidentiality*
 - Never share confidential or proprietary information about Sapien, its clients, or partners on social media.
 - Avoid discussing sensitive internal matters, ongoing projects, or non-public information.
- *Respectful Conduct*
 - Maintain a respectful and professional tone when posting online, even on personal accounts.
 - Do not post content that could be considered discriminatory, harassing, offensive, or harmful to Sapien’s reputation.
- *Use of Company Name and Branding*

- Employees may not use Sapien's name, logo, or branding in personal social media profiles without permission.
- Any use of branding for professional purposes (e.g., LinkedIn) must align with company guidelines.

Prohibited Actions

Employees must not:

- Share trade secrets, intellectual property, or insider information.
- Post derogatory remarks about colleagues, clients, or competitors.
- Engage in arguments or inappropriate debates online that could negatively impact Sapien.

Social Media for Work Purposes

- Employees who manage official company social media accounts must adhere to approved content strategies and guidelines.
- Content representing Sapien AI must be professional, accurate, and aligned with company values.

Disciplinary Action

- Failure to adhere to this policy may lead to appropriate corrective action, which could include, in serious cases, termination of employment or contractual engagement.
- Sapien AI reserves the right to request the removal of posts that violate this policy.

Questions or Concerns

For clarification about this policy or to report misuse of social media, contact HR@sapien.io

7.5 Equal Opportunity & Anti-Discrimination

Sapien is committed to creating a diverse, equitable, and inclusive workplace where every employee is treated with respect and dignity. This policy ensures that all employees, contractors, and job applicants are provided equal opportunities and protected from discrimination or harassment in any form.

Scope

This policy applies to all aspects of employment at Sapien, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, and termination. It is applicable to all employees, contractors, and job applicants, regardless of their location, in compliance with Ontario's Human Rights Code.

Policy Statement

1. Equal Opportunity

Sapien AI provides equal employment opportunities to all individuals, regardless of:

- Race, color, or ethnicity
- Gender, gender identity, or gender expression
- Age
- Sexual orientation
- Marital or family status
- Religion or creed
- Disability (physical or mental)
- Any other characteristic protected under applicable laws.

2. Prohibited Discrimination and Harassment

Discrimination or harassment of any kind is strictly prohibited. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- Unequal treatment in hiring, promotions, or compensation based on a protected characteristic.
- Offensive comments, jokes, or behavior related to race, gender, religion, or any other protected category.
- Sexual harassment, including unwelcome advances, inappropriate remarks, or any behavior that creates a hostile work environment.

3. Recruitment and Hiring

- Sapien AI ensures a fair and unbiased recruitment process by focusing on skills, qualifications, and merit.
- Job descriptions and postings are designed to attract diverse candidates.

4. Accessibility and Accommodations

- Sapien AI provides reasonable accommodations to employees and applicants with disabilities, ensuring they can perform essential job functions.
- Employees requiring accommodations should contact HR@sapien.io to discuss their needs confidentially.

Reporting and Resolving Complaints

1. Reporting Discrimination or Harassment

- Employees who experience or witness discrimination or harassment are encouraged to report it promptly to their manager or HR@sapien.io
- Complaints can be submitted anonymously if desired, though this may limit the ability to investigate fully.

2. Investigation Process

- Sapien AI will investigate all complaints promptly, thoroughly, and confidentially.
- Investigations may involve interviews with the complainant, respondent, and any witnesses.
- A report of findings and actions taken will be provided to the complainant and respondent.

3. Protection from Retaliation

- Retaliation against employees who report discrimination or harassment in good faith is strictly prohibited.

Consequences of Violations

- Failure to adhere to this policy may lead to appropriate corrective action, which could include, in serious cases, termination of employment or contractual engagement.

Commitment to Diversity and Inclusion

Sapien AI continuously works to promote diversity and inclusion by:

- Regularly reviewing hiring and promotion practices to ensure fairness.
- Encouraging open dialogue and feedback from employees about workplace culture.

Questions?

For more information or to discuss this policy, contact HR@sapien.io

7.6 Workplace Harassment

Sapien is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and inclusive workplace. This policy outlines our commitment to preventing and addressing workplace harassment and managing complaints in accordance with Ontario law.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, interns, and any individuals performing work on behalf of Sapien AI. It covers conduct that occurs:

- In the workplace.
- During work-related events or functions.
- In any work-related communication (including email, messaging platforms, or social media).

Definitions: Workplace Harassment

Workplace harassment is defined as engaging in a course of vexatious comment or conduct that is known or ought reasonably to be known as unwelcome. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Bullying, intimidation, or threats.
- Verbal abuse or inappropriate comments about someone's race, gender, age, disability, or other protected characteristics.
- Sexual harassment, including unwelcome advances, requests for sexual favors, or inappropriate touching.

Employee Rights and Responsibilities

- Employees have the right to work in an environment free from harassment and to report concerns without fear of retaliation.
- Employees are responsible for treating others with respect and promptly reporting any instances of harassment or complaints.

Reporting Workplace Harassment or Complaints

1. Making a Complaint:

- Employees are encouraged to report incidents of workplace harassment as soon as possible.
- Complaints can be made to the HR department at HR@sapien.io or directly to your manager.

2. Anonymous Reporting:

- Complaints may be made anonymously; however, anonymity may limit the ability to fully investigate the issue.

Investigation Process

1. Initial Review:

- Upon receiving a complaint, Sapien AI will conduct a preliminary review to determine if the complaint falls under workplace harassment.

2. *Investigation:*

- An impartial investigator (internal or external) will be appointed to investigate the complaint.
- The investigation will include interviews with the complainant, respondent, and any witnesses, as well as a review of relevant documents.

3. *Confidentiality:*

- All complaints and investigations will be handled with the utmost confidentiality, shared only with those necessary for resolving the matter.

4. *Outcome:*

- A written report of findings will be provided to the complainant and respondent upon conclusion of the investigation.
- If harassment is found to have occurred, Sapien will take appropriate corrective action, which may include disciplinary measures up to and including termination.

Protection Against Retaliation

- Sapien prohibits retaliation against employees who report harassment or participate in an investigation. Retaliation will be treated as a serious violation of this policy.

Training and Awareness

Sapien AI will provide regular training to all employees and managers to:

- Raise awareness about workplace harassment.
- Outline reporting procedures.
- Reinforce the importance of maintaining a respectful workplace.

Review and Compliance

- This policy will be reviewed annually or as required to comply with changes to Ontario law.

For more information or to discuss this policy, contact HR@sapien.io

7.7 Drugs & Alcohol

Sapien is committed to maintaining a safe, productive, and professional work environment. This policy establishes guidelines for drug and alcohol use to ensure employees can perform their duties effectively while protecting the integrity of our remote workplace.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and representatives of Sapien. It governs behavior during working hours, at work-related events, and while representing the company in any capacity.

Policy Guidelines

1. Prohibited Conduct

Employees must not:

- Work under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs, or any substance that impairs their ability to perform job duties safely and effectively.
- Possess, use, distribute, or sell illegal drugs or alcohol during working hours or while using company resources.
- Misuse prescription medication in a way that affects job performance.

2. Alcohol Use

- Alcohol consumption during work hours is prohibited unless explicitly authorized for a work-related event.
- Employees are expected to drink responsibly at company-sponsored events and maintain professionalism at all times.

3. Medical Cannabis and Prescription Drugs

- Employees who use medical cannabis or prescription drugs that may impair their ability to perform their job must inform HR@sapien.io confidentially.
- Sapien will provide reasonable accommodations where possible, in accordance with Ontario's Human Rights Code, while ensuring workplace safety and productivity.

4. Remote Work Considerations

- While working remotely, employees are expected to maintain the same standards of professionalism as they would in an office environment.
- Being impaired during work hours, even in a remote setting, is strictly prohibited.

Reporting Concerns

- If an employee suspects a colleague is under the influence or is engaging in behavior that compromises workplace safety or productivity, they are encouraged to report it confidentially to HR@sapien.io or their manager.
- All reports will be handled with discretion and investigated promptly.

Support and Rehabilitation

- Sapien supports employees who seek help for substance-related issues. Employees are encouraged to reach out to HR@sapien.io for access to confidential support
- Requests for leave or accommodations related to substance use treatment will be handled confidentially and in accordance with Ontario's Employment Standards Act (ESA) and Human Rights Code.

Consequences of Violations

- Failure to adhere to this policy may lead to appropriate corrective action, which could include, in serious cases, termination of employment or contractual engagement.
- Legal action may be pursued for violations involving illegal substances.

Questions?

For more information or assistance, contact HR@sapien.io

8. Technology

8.1 Learning & Development

Sapien is committed to fostering a culture of continuous learning and professional growth. This policy outlines how the company supports employees in enhancing their skills and knowledge to achieve both personal and organizational success.

Scope

This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Sapien AI. Contractors and interns may be eligible for certain opportunities at the discretion of their manager or HR.

Learning Opportunities

1. Training and Workshops

- Sapien is aiming offer internal and external training sessions, workshops, and webinars to develop job-specific skills, leadership abilities, and emerging technology knowledge.
- Employees are encouraged to participate in relevant opportunities aligned with their roles.

2. Professional Development Reimbursement

- In the future, Employees may request reimbursement for courses, certifications, or conferences that are directly related to their job or career growth within Sapien.
- Reimbursement Limit: **Up to \$1,500 CAD per year per employee.**
- Requests must be pre-approved by the employee's manager and HR.

3. Internal Knowledge Sharing

- Employees are encouraged to share knowledge and expertise through team presentations, lunch-and-learn sessions, or mentoring programs.

4. Learning Platforms

- Sapien may provide access to online learning platforms (e.g., Coursera, LinkedIn Learning) for continuous skill development.

Eligibility and Guidelines

1. Eligibility for Reimbursement

- Employees must be actively employed by Sapien at the time of course or program completion to qualify for reimbursement.
- Training must directly benefit the employee's current role or align with company goals.

2. Approval Process

- Employees must submit a formal request to their manager, including details of the course, program, or event, its cost, and how it benefits their role.
- Approval from HR is required for any expense exceeding \$1,500 CAD or for programs unrelated to current responsibilities but beneficial to long-term growth.

3. Time Off for Learning

- Employees may request time off during work hours to attend training sessions, exams, or conferences. This must be pre-approved by their manager.

Commitment to Diversity and Inclusion

- Sapien strives to offer learning opportunities that are inclusive and accessible to employees of all backgrounds.
- Employees with disabilities may request accommodations to participate in training programs.

Employee Responsibilities

- Take ownership of personal and professional growth by actively pursuing learning opportunities.
- Apply newly acquired skills to improve performance and contribute to team goals.
- Share knowledge with colleagues whenever possible to foster a culture of learning.

Company Support

Sapien is dedicated to:

- Providing a budget for employee development.
- Encouraging managers to support team members in identifying relevant learning opportunities.
- Regularly assessing the effectiveness of learning programs and seeking feedback from employees.

Reporting and Questions

For inquiries about training opportunities, reimbursement requests, or suggestions for development programs, contact HR@sapien.io

8.2 Confidentiality and Data-Protection

At Sapien AI, protecting confidential information and safeguarding data is critical to our operations and reputation. This policy outlines the responsibilities of employees, contractors, and representatives to ensure the security and integrity of company, client, and user data.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, interns, and third-party service providers. It covers the handling of all sensitive information, including but not limited to company data, intellectual property, client information, and personal data.

Definitions

- **Confidential Information:** Any non-public information related to Sapien AI's business, clients, users, or employees. This includes, but is not limited to, trade secrets, financial data, customer databases, product designs, algorithms, and proprietary software.
- **Personal Data:** Information that identifies an individual, such as names, email addresses, IP addresses, or any other data protected under applicable privacy laws (e.g., PIPEDA, GDPR).
- **Data Breach:** Unauthorized access, disclosure, or loss of confidential information or personal data.

Responsibilities

1. *Safeguarding Confidential Information*

- Access confidential information only on a need-to-know basis and for authorized business purposes.
- Do not share confidential information with unauthorized individuals, both inside and outside the organization.

2. *Data Protection*

- Store and process personal data in compliance with PIPEDA and other applicable data protection laws.
- Use company approved tools and systems to store and transfer sensitive information securely.
- Report any data breach or suspicious activity immediately to IT@sapien.io.

3. *Secure Use of Technology*

- Use strong, unique passwords for all accounts and devices.
- Avoid accessing company systems or sensitive data over unsecured networks (e.g., public Wi-Fi).
- Do not install unauthorized software or hardware on company devices.

Prohibited Actions

- Sharing passwords or login credentials with unauthorized parties.
- Discussing confidential information in public places or on unsecured communication channels.
- Storing company data on personal devices without prior approval.
- Using company information for personal gain or outside business ventures.

Data Retention and Disposal

- Retain data only as long as necessary for business or legal purposes.
- Dispose of physical documents and digital files securely, using shredders or approved data-wiping methods.

Reporting and Response

- Report any potential breaches, loss, or theft of confidential information or devices immediately to HR@sapien.io
- Sapien AI will investigate all incidents and take appropriate corrective measures, which may include notifying affected parties and authorities if required by law.

Consequences of Non-Compliance

- Failure to adhere to this policy may lead to appropriate corrective action, which could include, in serious cases, termination of employment or contractual engagement.
- Legal action may be taken in cases of intentional misconduct or negligence.

Acknowledgment

- All employees, contractors, and service providers must sign a confidentiality agreement as a condition of employment or engagement with Sapien AI.

Questions?

For clarification or additional guidance, contact HR@sapien.io or IT@sapien.io

9. Compensation

This outlines Sapien AI's compensation philosophy, including not just salary, but also equity and token-based incentives. The aim is to promote transparency and equity in reward systems for all employees.

9.1 Salary

Salary bands are defined by role and experience, with regular market benchmarking conducted to ensure competitiveness.

9.2 Equity & Token Grants

Eligible employees may receive equity or token-based compensation. Details include:

- **Eligibility:** Full-time permanent employees unless otherwise specified.
- **Grant Structure:** Options or tokens may vest over a 4-year schedule with a 1-year cliff.
- **Vesting Milestones:** Set in employment agreement; may be accelerated in certain exit scenarios.
- **Taxation:** Grants are subject to applicable income and capital gains taxes in the employee's country.

For questions, contact: HR@sapien.io

10. Grievance and Dispute Resolution

Creating a respectful and open environment also means providing a clear and fair process for employees to raise concerns. This section describes the steps Sapien employees can take to report and resolve disputes.

Sapien encourages employees to address concerns early. The process is:

1. **Informal Resolution:** Discuss concerns with your direct manager.
2. **Escalation:** If unresolved, submit a written complaint to HR at HR@sapien.io
3. **Investigation:** HR will investigate all formal complaints confidentially.
4. **Resolution:** Findings and recommendations will be shared within 15 business days.

Sapien strictly prohibits retaliation for good faith complaints. Anonymous submissions are accepted but may limit investigative follow-up.

11. Intellectual Property & Side Projects

As a technology-driven company, protecting our innovations and respecting personal creative work are both crucial. This section clarifies the boundaries between company and employee-created work and the expectations around side projects.

Employees may engage in side projects outside of Sapien working hours. However:

- Any project created using Sapien resources or during work hours belongs to Sapien.
- All side projects must be disclosed to HR and approved if there is any potential overlap.
- Use of company IP, code, data, or designs in personal work is strictly prohibited.

Questions should be directed to: HR@sapien.io

Document Control

Version History

Version	Date	Revised By	Nature of Amendment

Reference Documents

Document

Document / Design Owner

Name	Title
Tyler Koverko	Data Protection Officer

Document Contributors

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Document Review

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